At the Supreme Court, Bajaj made it clear that she had pursued legal proceedings as a matter of principle and had no intention of withdrawing the compensation of Rs 2,00,000 that Gill had been ordered to deposit. The court therefore directed that the compensation be paid over to a women's rights organization. Even after the Supreme Court's final decision in this case, Gill's lawyer downplayed the judgement as 'academic' since it imposed no practical disqualifications on Gill.[47] Bajaj campaigned, ultimately unsuccessfully, to have Gill's Padma Shri withdrawn.

This case left behind a complex legacy. Throughout the proceedings and thereafter, Bajaj emphasized the broader significance of her case to the women's rights movement. However, Sections 354 and 509 of the IPC were grounded in Victorian conceptions of modesty and honour. These sections typecast women as meek and modest, with crimes arising from the violation of this notion of modesty. The disquieting consequence of framing crimes of sexual assault and harassment in this way was that they appeared to afford protection only to women that retained the quality of modesty. As an upper-class married woman with a powerful husband, and attending a party at which men and women congregated in separate semicircles, Mrs Bajaj matched this description perfectly. As one scholar observed, Bajaj 'called upon a Victorian law to win a remarkably Victorian case, thus enshrining in precedent the image of the working woman as married, modest, surrounded by her stalwart husband and circle of proper "ladies"'.[48] Bajaj presented herself consistent with this narrative. In an interview given shortly after the Supreme Court's final decision, she said, 'If I had not protested then who is supposed to, my class IV employee or peon? I am a role model because of where I am, I just had to.'[49]

Would agricultural labourers or manual scavengers benefit from the same legal protections? Perhaps it would be much too easy to dismiss their claims for the reason that since they had relinquished their 'modesty', there was nothing left to protect. On a separate occasion, Mrs Bajaj said, 'I am not a woman from the roadside. I have had 6,000 men working under me.'[50] It is unthinkable that 'a woman from the roadside', in particular a lower-caste